

Reverb — Product Requirements Document (PRD)

Project Overview

Title

Reverb

Introduction

Students, athletes, and professionals today face a shared paradox: the volume of information they're expected to absorb keeps growing, while the uninterrupted time available to process it keeps shrinking. Between classes, practices, commutes, morning routines, and back-to-back meetings, the hours that could be spent learning, reviewing, and organizing are constantly being crowded out; not because people are lazy, but because traditional tools demand focused desk time that most people just don't have.

Reverb is an AI-powered audio platform that transforms a user's schedule, deadlines, coursework, and meeting notes into personalized, on-demand audio. Every morning, Reverb delivers a smart daily briefing, synthesized from the user's GCal, email, Canvas, and Slack (or other tools like Notion or Outlook), that runs through priorities, flags what's coming, and surfaces anything urgent, all in the time it takes to get ready. When something important is on the horizon, users can switch into Study Mode and have Reverb teach them the relevant material in podcast, lecture, or interactive quiz form. And because every session, transcript, and recording lives in one searchable hub, nothing said or learned ever gets lost. Where most productivity tools stop at awareness, Reverb closes the loop with an AI-powered Action Stack that breaks your workload into realistic work blocks and actively prompts you throughout the day on what to do next.

Reverb doesn't ask users to change their habits. It fits inside the time they're already spending and makes it count.

User Persona: The Busy Student

Basic Information

- Name: Maya Chen
- Age: 20
- Occupation: Sophomore, Government/Econ double major

- Location: New Haven, Connecticut

Photo

Background

Maya is a full-time student at a competitive university, balancing two demanding majors alongside a part-time campus job and involvement in two student organizations. She went to a similarly competitive high school and puts significant pressure on herself academically, but has struggled to build sustainable study habits as her course load has intensified. She often feels reactive rather than organized, well aware that deadlines are coming but unclear on how to sequence her time.

Goals and Motivations

- *Primary Goal:* Stay on top of readings and assignments and prepare for career recruiting.
- *Secondary Goal:* Reduce decision fatigue around what to work on and when and succeed in clubs.
- *Motivation:* Maya is driven by academic performance and the desire to feel in control of her schedule. She responds well to structure and gets anxious when things feel scattered. Knowing she's prepared for what's ahead gives her peace of mind.

Frustrations and Pain Points

- 1) Switching between Canvas, Google Calendar, Gmail, Slack, and her notes app means important deadlines regularly slip through
- 2) She has no shortage of study time in theory, but consistently loses it to indecision about what to prioritize
- 3) Traditional study methods require her full attention at a desk, which conflicts with her packed schedule
- 4) She forgets some verbal information from professors and in meetings after office hours end

Technology Proficiency

Maya is highly comfortable with technology and uses a wide range of productivity and academic tools daily. She's an early adopter by habit and frequently tries new apps, looking for something that actually fits her workflow (think Notion because she heard about it from her friends, lots of AI tools), though she's also quick to drop tools that require too much manual upkeep.

Behaviors and Habits

Checks email first thing every morning; keeps a rough to-do list in her notes app that she updates inconsistently; usually spends 45 min - 1 hr getting ready in the morning or for going out; spends Sunday evenings trying to mentally map out the week ahead; frequently studies with background music (think jazz or classical).

Preferred Channels

Word of mouth from friends and classmates is the primary discovery channel, which she's used to from her high school and in college, crowdsourcing strategies for managing a rigorous academic life. She also follows productivity and student life content on TikTok and YouTube (watched all those college admissions people on TikTok in high school and now watches that one guy who won't shut up about finance + other career-specific FYP content creators), and responds well to app recommendations embedded in campus communities (clubs) or academic newsletters.

Quote

"I know everything that's due, I just never know what to actually do right now. And when I figure it out, I've already wasted an hour."

How Our Product Helps

The product aggregates Maya's Canvas assignments, Slack, calendar, and email into a single daily briefing she can listen to while getting ready, giving her a clear priority stack before she's even left her room. When a big exam or paper is approaching, she can upload her readings and have the product teach her the material while she walks to class or goes on the Stairmaster. Office hours feedback gets recorded and integrated into her study plan automatically.

Scenario

It's Wednesday morning, and Maya has a midterm in two days on Friday. While doing her skincare routine, she plays that morning's briefing: it runs through her day's schedule, flags the midterm, and surfaces two unread emails from her professor with clarifications posted to Canvas. The app recommends she start to review the material. She switches into Podcast Mode for her twenty-minute walk to class, where two AI hosts break down the lecture material she uploaded the night before. By the time she sits down in her first class, she has a structured approach to her day while feeling productive.

Market Analysis

Competitor Analysis

The audio productivity space has no direct competitor to Reverb, but adjacent products occupy parts of the problem space. Notion AI and other AI writing assistants help users organize information, but are entirely text-based and require active engagement at a screen. Podcast apps like Spotify and Apple Podcasts deliver audio content but are entirely static because they have no awareness of a user's schedule, priorities, or coursework. Tools like Otter.ai and Fireflies offer meeting transcription but stop there, with no synthesis, briefing, or study functionality built on top. Academic tools like Canvas and Google Classroom manage assignments and deadlines, but make no attempt to help students actually process or retain the material. NotebookLM from Google offers podcast generation and study guide creation from files but its not proactive (the user must input the data) and it isn't focused on broader lifestyle support. No product currently combines calendar integration, personalized audio generation, study content delivery, and meeting transcription into a single, unified experience.

Market Opportunity

The gap Reverb addresses is structural: existing tools are built for users who have time to sit down and engage with a screen. The large and growing population of students, athletes, and professionals who are perpetually in motion (commuting, working out, getting ready, traveling) has no tool designed around their actual constraints. Podcast consumption among 18–34 year olds has grown steadily for a decade, demonstrating that this demographic is already comfortable with audio as a primary information format. Reverb simply applies that format to the information users already need to engage with: their schedule, their coursework, their meetings. Beyond format, existing tools share a second limitation: they surface information but stop short of driving action. Reverb bridges that gap by combining awareness with execution, actively guiding them through getting it done.

Features

Feature 1: Daily Audio Briefing

- Description: Every morning, Reverb generates a personalized audio briefing by pulling from the user's connected apps (Google Calendar, Gmail, Canvas, Slack, Notion, and others). The briefing covers the day's schedule, upcoming deadlines, flagged emails, and a synthesized priority stack of what the user should actually focus on today, ranked by urgency and importance. The tone is conversational and human, modeled after the cadence of a morning radio or podcast host, not a screen reader. Think “The Daily” from the New York Times but for your own life.
- Priority: High
- Effort: High

Feature 2: Study Mode (Lecture, Podcast, and Response Formats)

- Description: Users can upload course materials (syllabi, readings, lecture slides, notes) and Reverb generates on-demand audio study content in one of three formats.
 - *Lecture Mode* delivers the material as a structured solo presentation.
 - *Podcast Mode* stages a conversation between two AI hosts who discuss, debate, and unpack the content together.
 - *Response Mode* turns the session into an active recall exercise, prompting the user verbally and evaluating their spoken answers in real time with feedback and follow-up questions.
- Priority: High
- Effort: High

Feature 3: Meeting & Conversation Recording

- Description: Users can record any conversation directly within Reverb such as a professor's office hours feedback, a club meeting, a client call, a study group session. Reverb transcribes the recording, extracts key action items and takeaways, and integrates the relevant information into the next day's briefing as reminders or follow-up prompts. The full transcript is stored and searchable in the user's personal library.
- Priority: High
- Effort: Medium

Feature 4: Transcript Library & Daily One-Pager

- Description: Every transcript, uploaded document, and study session is stored in a searchable personal library within Reverb, giving users a running archive of everything they've engaged with. Alongside the audio briefing, Reverb also generates a concise daily one-pager in text, which is a clean, skimmable text summary of the day's priorities and deadlines. The one-pager is designed for the moments when a user sits down briefly and wants a fast written snapshot rather than audio.
- Priority: Medium
- Effort: Medium

Feature 5: Integration Ecosystem

- Description: Reverb connects to the tools users already use via OAuth (GCal, Gmail, Canvas, Blackboard, Notion, Slack, Outlook, and iCal). Setup takes under five minutes. Once connected, Reverb continuously pulls relevant data to keep the daily briefing current and accurate without requiring manual input from the user.
- Priority: High
- Effort: High

Feature 6: Streaks & Progress Gamification

- Description: Reverb tracks daily engagement through a lightweight gamification system based around daily streaks for listening to a briefing or completing a study session, subject mastery progress bars per course, weekly audio recaps summarizing what was covered and what's ahead, and milestone badges for first streaks, first exam prep, and first active recall session completed.
- Priority: Low
- Effort: Low

Feature 7: AI-Powered Action Stack

- Description: While the daily one-pager informs and the briefing orients, the Action Stack is where Reverb moves from awareness to execution. Using the same data pulled from the user's integrations (e.g. deadlines, calendar blocks, recorded meeting action items, and uploaded materials) Reverb generates a prioritized, actionable to-do list ranked by urgency and the user's available time. Larger tasks are automatically broken into smaller, time-bounded work blocks that fit realistically within the user's day. Throughout the day, Reverb sends smart push notifications prompting the user on what to tackle next through specific nudges to start, continue, or wrap up a defined block of work. Users can interact with the Action Stack by marking items complete, snoozing blocks, or asking Reverb to re-prioritize based on a change in their schedule.
- Priority: High
- Effort: High

Feature Prioritization

Prioritization Framework

Must-have:

- Daily Audio Briefing
- Integration Ecosystem
- Study Mode (Lecture, Podcast, Response)

Should-have:

- Meeting & Conversation Recording
- Transcript Library & Daily One-Pager
- Action Stack

Could-have:

- Streaks & Progress Gamification
- Pre-Interview / Mock Interview Mode

Prioritization Criteria

- User need: Does the feature effectively address the user's pain point?
- Impact: How much value does the feature add to the user experience?
- Feasibility: How achievable is the development of the feature within the given resources and allotted time period?
- User Feedback: Does user demand support this feature?

Prioritized Features

1. Short-form Highlight Clips (Must-have)
2. Swipe Interface (Could-Have)
3. Athlete Profiles (Should-Have)
4. Direct Messaging (Won't-Have)

Milestones

- Month 1: Market Research Completion
- Month 1-2: Integration & API Scoping
- Month 2-3: MVP Development (Briefing + 1 Integration)
- Month 4: Study Mode Development
- Month 4-5: Recording & Transcription Feature
- Month 5-6: Internal User Testing
- Month 6-7: Iteration Based on Feedback
- Month 7: Beta Launch

Metrics for Success

- Daily Active Users (DAU): Number of users playing the daily briefing on a given day
- Study Session Completion Rate: Percentage of study sessions started that are completed in full, indicating content quality and user commitment
- Streak Retention Rate: Percentage of users maintaining a 7-day streak, signaling habit formation
- Feature Adoption Rate: Percentage of active users who have used each major feature (briefing, study mode, recording) at least once
- Churn Rate: Percentage of users who stop using Reverb after the first week, indicating whether the product solves the problem well enough to retain users past initial curiosity
- Recording-to-Briefing Integration Rate: Percentage of recorded meetings that surface at least one action item in the following day's briefing, measuring whether the pipeline works end-to-end

Conclusion

Reverb addresses a structural gap in how students and professionals manage information and learning. Existing tools assume focused screen time that most users don't have, but Reverb is built for the reality of lives already in motion. By delivering personalized audio across a daily briefing, adaptive study formats, and integrated meeting transcription, Reverb turns the dead time in any day into productive hours. The immediate target users are college students and student athletes, with a natural expansion path toward busy professionals. The initial scope is deliberately focused on the briefing, the study modes, and the recording pipeline, with a clear roadmap for the collaborative and advanced features that follow.